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Messaging guide: Red Hat's approach to sovereign cloud

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How to use this document

This guide provides internal stakeholders with consistent messaging for sales, marketing, and partners. The goal is to build consensus on Red Hat's approach to digital sovereignty and provide an intellectual foundation for content creation.

Executive summary

The global push for digital sovereignty by companies and government agencies has become more than a regulatory requirement—it is now a strategic priority driven by geopolitics, economics, national security concerns, the critical need to protect infrastructure and intellectual property, and the foundational goal of achieving technological self-reliance and digital autonomy. This is especially true for AI, which is seen as a strategic driver, shaping national competitiveness, and public trust. Efforts to develop sovereign cloud and sovereign AI solutions worldwide face challenges such as legal conflicts, technical fragmentation, and the delicate balance between local control and access to innovative technologies. To succeed, it is crucial to move beyond merely responding to data localization issues and adopt proactive measures towards technological independence.

Overview

Digital sovereignty is no longer just a geopolitical concern—it is a strategic business imperative driven by the need to increase control and resiliency while reducing business and compliance risk. Every organization faces the same challenge: How do you regain control of your technology infrastructure and operations, safeguard your data and supply chain, and comply with national regulations and policies, all while continuing to deliver reliable services and without sacrificing the flexibility and innovation required for the AI era?

You've seen the options: Go with a hyperscaler and get locked into their stack and their rules; try a small local vendor and risk not having the technology capabilities or support you need; or build it yourself with open source and struggle with the cost and complexity.

Red Hat eliminates compromise. Our open hybrid cloud architecture provides the transparency, security, and auditability required to meet your business needs and the strictest sovereignty mandates. Importantly, it gives you the flexibility to run your critical workloads, including AI workloads, consistently across your datacenters and any public cloud—securing control while preserving your freedom to innovate anywhere.

For our customers facing the most stringent demands—especially those in Europe—we offer Red Hat Confirmed Sovereign Support, a dedicated, EU-based support team of EU citizens, providing verifiable operational sovereignty and control over critical IT operations.

Open source is the driving force behind this capability. It is the only foundation that offers the verifiable transparency necessary for true sovereignty—something closed, proprietary stacks simply cannot deliver. As a leader in global open source for more than 30 years, Red Hat has delivered trusted, enterprise open source solutions to customers that have the most stringent security and compliance requirements. We can help you achieve your strategic control, resiliency and compliance objectives, and eliminate dependencies and risk.

Customer challenges

Sovereignty is a global issue. In recent analyst reports, the market is clearly influenced by concerns about digital sovereignty.

85%	79%	93%
of cloud decision-makers say that sovereignty constraints completely or partially influence their choice of cloud vendor.	of countries with legislation in privacy and data protection	view global collaboration as essential for building secure and culturally aligned sovereign AI systems.
Forrester, The Sovereign Cloud Platform Landscape, Q4 2025 , Oct. 2025.	United Nations, Trade and Development: Privacy and Protection Data , Feb. 2025.	Linux Foundation, "The State of Sovereign AI: Exploring the Role of Open Source Projects and Global Collaboration in Global AI Strategy" , Aug. 2025.



We have also received direct feedback from customers and partners that supports these analyst claims. Beyond concerns about data residency and transparency, customers and partners have also voiced worries about:

- **Vendor control:** Organizations want solutions that reduce reliance on hyperscalers or proprietary technology stacks, enabling them to migrate workloads and avoid vendor dependency.
- **Trust and security:** Customers are concerned about the security of deployed technology, especially amid increasing cybersecurity threats from state and non-state actors. They also question whether software has backdoors or hidden code. Customers seek clarity on what to expect from a US-based company regarding security and options.
- **Regulatory demands:** Changing global regulations—such as the EU's General Data Protection Regulations (GDPR), Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA), India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, NIS2, and the AI Act—make sovereignty a legal requirement. See [Appendix B](#) for a more detailed list of regional regulations.
- **Geopolitical risk:** Rising geopolitical tensions increase the demand for greater technical independence and national self-sufficiency. It is important to note that countries and organizations view risks differently. While some are more concerned that reliance on certain technologies could lead to disruptions or restrictions, others are hyper-focused on operational and supply chain risk (e.g., access to GPUs).

At its core, digital sovereignty is an organization's or nation's ability to exert control over its own digital infrastructure, data, and technology. This control can be understood across 4 fundamental dimensions:

- **Data sovereignty:** Maintaining control over how data is collected, classified, processed, and stored to ensure data regulations are met, including the legal control of AI models and training data.
- **Technical sovereignty:** Running workloads, including non-sovereign GenAI models, without dependence on a provider's infrastructure or software, and protected from all extraterritorial interference and scrutiny.
- **Operational sovereignty:** Gaining visibility and control over provider operations from provisioning and performance management to monitoring of physical and digital access to the infrastructure.
- **Assurance sovereignty:** The ability to independently verify and assure the integrity, security, and reliability of digital systems and processes, including the resilience of critical services.

Customer solution options

Sovereignty is rarely solved by a single provider. Red Hat offers customers and partners choice; the choice to build a sovereign cloud across a range of infrastructure providers and cloud zones, rather than limiting our customers to a single solution. This ensures high availability, resilience against outages, and strict adherence to data residency laws by allowing customers to match workloads to the specific infrastructure, security, or compliance model they require.

- **Hyperscalers** Hyperscalers are a powerful foundation, and Red Hat partners closely with them to maximize their value. However, relying solely on native stacks can create vendor dependencies and limit flexibility.



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- **Short pitch:** Red Hat allows you to use the global scale of hyperscalers while maintaining total control over your applications. By overlaying Red Hat's hybrid cloud platform, you create a portable environment where workloads can move fluidly between providers and availability zones to ensure resilience, without being locked into a single compliance or security model.
- **Local technology vendors** Local vendors are often essential for meeting specific data residency and jurisdictional requirements. The challenge is ensuring they can also meet the scalability and security standards of a global enterprise.
 - **Short pitch:** You can use local vendors for their regulatory compliance benefits while relying on Red Hat to provide the enterprise technology layer on top. This allows customers to build a sovereign solution that respects local laws but operates with the global security standards, stability, and operational consistency that today's business demands.
- **Using open source directly** Open source is the standard for transparency and innovation, which are key to sovereignty. However, operationalizing upstream code across multizone environments is complex and requires significant internal resources for maintenance and security.
 - **Short pitch:** Red Hat bridges the gap between community innovation and enterprise requirements. We allow customers to build on trusted, transparent open source technologies to ensure sovereignty, while we handle the security hardening, support, and lifecycle management needed to maintain high availability across diverse cloud infrastructure.

Why Red Hat?

Red Hat offers sovereign capabilities that empower our customers to achieve resilience, autonomy, and independence. Our open source commitment provides the fundamental transparency necessary to build the high degree of trust required for sovereign cloud adoption. The open hybrid cloud model ensures unparalleled control through deployment choice, allowing organizations to maintain strategic autonomy and prepare investments against evolving risks. This unique approach offers choice and flexibility, while fostering a competitive regional ecosystem. Our commitment rests on 5 pillars:

Pillar 1: The open source model—Transparency is control

Open source is the foundation that enables organizations to obtain the transparency and control they need over their technology and operations. Red Hat relies on open standards and source code inspection to reduce hidden risk and malicious code dependencies. Red Hat delivers cryptographically signed software with verified provenance and integrity. This approach provides the auditable security essential for trust in critical infrastructure. It prevents dependence on a single vendor—the core threat to technical independence.

Pillar 2: Hybrid cloud architecture—Flexibility unlocks choice

The open hybrid cloud is the architecture of autonomy. Red Hat OpenShift provides a single, consistent platform that unifies diverse hardware, including NVIDIA, AMD, Intel, and other GPUs. In addition, it allows organizations to run applications anywhere—on premise in local partner clouds or at the edge. This flexibility ensures workload portability, allowing rapid automated migration across environments in response to regulatory or geopolitical changes. Red Hat Enterprise Linux provides a consistent, security-focused operating foundation for all sovereign workloads, simplifying management across diverse locations. Red Hat Ansible Automation Platform delivers operational autonomy by automating IT operations, establishing sovereign boundaries and process controls, and enforcing compliance at scale.



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Pillar 3: Comprehensive security and resilience—Protecting critical infrastructure

Sovereignty requires security. We focus on enhancing organizational resilience to protect critical infrastructure from disruption and mitigate the risks posed by regulations such as DORA. Our platform ensures protection goes beyond data residency. We provide tools for workload protection, including confidential computing and advanced encryption. Red Hat OpenShift facilitates integration with External Key Management Systems (EKMS), allowing customers to maintain exclusive control over encryption keys—a critical defense against extraterritorial legal access. Furthermore, we enable operational resilience through rapid disaster recovery (DR) and business continuity through automated failover and RPO/RTO enhancements, fortifying the software supply chain against external threats.

Pillar 4: Local ecosystem and support—Localized trust

Sovereign success relies on local partners who handle the physical and legal requirements, including in-country datacenters and local administrative staff. Red Hat maintains a global ecosystem of cloud providers, system integrators, and ISVs. Red Hat actively partners with local and global cloud providers to build tailored sovereign capabilities and services.

- **Messaging for EMEA messaging:** Enhanced EU sovereign compliance support commitment: We strengthen our commitment to partners across EU member countries. The support program accelerates compliance certification for local providers—the Cloud Service Providers (CSPs), Managed Service Providers (MSPs), and telecommunications (telco) service providers—operating within the EU. This specialized support and reference architectures help partners achieve high assurance levels (e.g., SEAL-3 and 4) required for public sector contracts. It provides artifacts and tools to address complex mandates like resilience (e.g., DORA) and software supply chain integrity (e.g., CRA).
- **Messaging for APAC and LATAM:** Red Hat will continue to collaborate with local and global partners to deliver innovative sovereign services to promote digital autonomy and increase technological self-reliance.

Pillar 5: Sovereign AI and innovation—Innovation under control

Organizations must control AI data, models, security, and infrastructure in accordance with local laws and strategies. Red Hat AI helps build and run sovereign AI workloads—from training to inference—ensuring compliance with data residency and ethical standards. Red Hat provides the foundation that supports Sovereign AI Factories or Model-as-a-Service (MaaS) solutions under local control.

Red Hat supports digital autonomy by providing an open source foundation centered on control, transparency, and resilience. For AI, the platform delivers a more security-focused and trusted runtime using a verified supply chain, signed artifacts, and zero trust architecture, governed by Policy as Code (PaC) for full lifecycle auditability. Furthermore, Red Hat supports cost-efficient, sovereign MaaS and high-performance inference, enabling predictable cost and operational independence through multivendor accelerator support. Finally, the reliance on open standards at every layer creates an open, modular architecture that ensures technology independence, transparent model behavior, and flexibility for local adaptation.



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Red Hat's blueprint for sovereignty

There are many ways to meet the sovereign requirements. And nearly all organizations already have elements of sovereignty in place. Currently, Red Hat helps our customers extend their sovereign capabilities in 2 primary deployment approaches.

Self-managed	Managed service providers (MSPs) and cloud service providers (CSPs)
Many of our customers have used our portfolio of products and services to build enterprise infrastructure to meet the requirements of their business. For this target market, Red Hat helps them build a private, sovereign infrastructure, deploying applications where they choose.	Supporting the MSP and CSP market to build sovereign capabilities that they can then offer to the market. Our partnership will take many forms: working with hyperscalers and local CSPs and with GSIs and ISVs to extend their services. In keeping with the message, Red Hat will continue to provide the software components that enable sovereignty. We need to be clear to the market that we are not a sovereign service provider. Our portfolio can be used to build something sovereign.

In addition to self-managed and MSP and CSP deployment, managed, and hyperscaler options are also under consideration.

Red Hat supports digital sovereignty. We do not build sovereign clouds. We deliver the technology foundation—software—that infrastructure providers (e.g., MSPs and CSPs) use to run their own compliant sovereign clouds and offer services to their customers.

The Red Hat Sovereign Cloud reference architecture

A secure, repeatable technical blueprint must support a sound sovereignty strategy. Red Hat provides an opinionated reference architecture for building a sovereign cloud designed to offer a comprehensive suite of Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS), Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS), and AI-as-a-Service (AlaaS) capabilities. The Red Hat reference architecture ensures consistency, control, and security capabilities across any environment.



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Sovereign Cloud Reference Architecture

Red Hat provides the foundation for IaaS, PaaS and AaaS

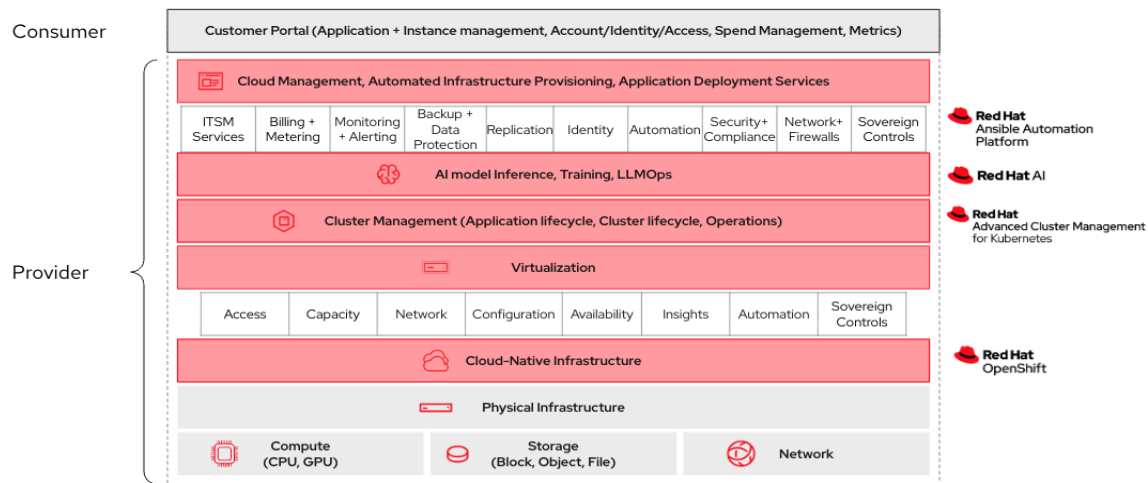


Image: A diagram of the Red Hat Sovereign Cloud architecture

This architecture is built on a layered model, with Red Hat's core products providing specific functions:

- The foundation is a layer of **cloud-native infrastructure** built on **Red Hat OpenShift**.
 - As the industry's leading application platform, Red Hat OpenShift provides a consistent, performant, and scalable foundation for running both modern and traditional applications across any physical, virtual, private, or public infrastructure.
 - In addition to portability across hybrid and multicloud environments, Red Hat OpenShift also has built-in auto-scaling and self-healing. Red Hat OpenShift provides resilience and workload protection with hardened security features on top of Kubernetes-native security and encryption practices. Red Hat OpenShift has native multitenancy capabilities with namespaces and role-based access control (RBAC) and has support for logical workload isolation and quota management for multiple tenants.
 - Core developer services (CI/CD, GitOps, etc.) are provided via **Red Hat OpenShift Pipelines**, ArgoCD, and **Red Hat Quay** to support software supply chain security for all applications.
- To deliver on the promise of sovereign AaaS, the architecture integrates **Red Hat AI**. This provides a single development platform for operational consistency across teams and environments, cuts time to market for AI applications, and offers hybrid cloud flexibility that lets data scientists and developers build, train, and deploy AI models and applications directly on the Red Hat OpenShift platform. By providing a consistent environment for the entire AI/ML lifecycle, Red Hat AI ensures that organizations can develop their own sovereign intelligence, keeping sensitive models and training data under their control and aligned with local governance.
- The management and automation layer sits above the development platform.



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- **Red Hat Ansible Automation Platform** is used for automated infrastructure provisioning, configuration management, and application deployment, ensuring that all processes are repeatable and codified.
- For multicluster environments, **Red Hat Advanced Cluster Management for Kubernetes** provides centralized cluster lifecycle management, application deployment, and, crucially, policy-based governance to enforce security and compliance settings consistently across the entire estate.

Our architecture explicitly supports running both virtual machines (VMs) and containers on a single, unified platform. This capability is critical for workload portability, allowing organizations to modernize at their own pace and avoid being locked into a single virtualization or containerization technology.

Customer references

Local cloud providers

- **Phoenix Technologies:** Phoenix Systems is a prominent Swiss sovereign cloud provider. Its flexible cloud platform, kvant Cloud, gives customers from a range of sectors a choice of public or private cloud with total reassurance that their data will be stored in Switzerland, managed by Swiss developers, and built on open source technologies, avoiding potential vendor lock-in.
- **ELCA** in Switzerland enhanced digital sovereignty and accelerated cloud adoption for highly regulated sectors using Red Hat OpenShift. They now offer a managed sovereign cloud, addressing security and compliance needs, and ensuring full data residency for critical projects like Justitia 4.0. Red Hat OpenShift also powers their SaaS and software factory, enabling automation and multitenancy to cut deployment times from weeks to hours, reduce costs, and simplify governance and compliance through better control and auditability.
- **NxtGen:** India's pursuit of AI sovereignty is being enabled by the collaboration between NxtGen Cloud Technologies and Red Hat, which uses open source principles to provide the autonomy needed to build and deploy AI solutions tailored to local needs and data regulations. By using Red Hat's open hybrid cloud technologies, NxtGen aims to create a trustworthy, transparent AI ecosystem to support national priorities.

Government

- **ResetData (internal reference—do not use publicly):** Australian sovereign AI provider. Red Hat enabled ResetData to build an AI Factory, meeting the Australian government's strict sovereign requirements. The reference is part of the Oct. 28, 2025 Company Meeting and can be viewed on Media Space (at 00:36:08).

Regulated industry

- **DenizBank:** Financial institutions operating in Turkey are subject to strict data sovereignty requirements. Working with Red Hat, DenizBank provided a consistent, compliant model development environment with automated pipelines and standards, improving productivity and time to market for a team of more than 150 data scientists.
- **BNP Paribas:** Keynote presentation at 2025 Summit Connect in Paris. BNP Paribas, collaborating with IBM and Red Hat are using Red Hat OpenShift AI in production within the AI factory platform. The sovereign, hybrid platform is based on the concepts of GPU-as-a-Service



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(GPUaaS) and LLM-as-a-Service (LLMaaS) to industrialize gen AI and make it available to the entire group.

Persona challenges and solutions

Target persona	Challenge	Business value
Business leader C-suite: CIO, CTO, CRO, CISO, CDO, COO; Line of Business Owner	Navigating complex regulations, building operational resilience, achieving cost effectiveness, and ensuring data location control	Red Hat gives CIOs the flexibility to manage workloads across diverse environments, including sovereign clouds, while meeting the industry's strict security requirements. Our platforms provide the clarity and auditability needed to navigate complex regulations and foster innovation.
AppDev ITDM VP of App Dev, Lead developer, enterprise developer, Senior or Lead Software Engineer (Developer leads are highly influential in purchase decisions.)	Threat of compromised software supply chain, unverified artifacts, and malicious code from foreign parties AI regulations, like the EU AI Act, mandate transparency, traceability, explainability, and auditability throughout the AI lifecycle. Compliance requires aligning infrastructure, models, and governance.	Red Hat provides a trusted software supply chain solution that enforces mandatory signing and verification of container images. In addition, Red Hat helps organizations to analyze and inspect Software Bill of Materials (SBOMs) for greater transparency and auditability. Sovereign AI requires control over data, models, cost, and security. Red Hat delivers a more security-focused, open, hybrid platform to build and operate AI on your terms. Maintain jurisdictional control, ensure auditability and trust, and scale AI efficiently across on premise, sovereign cloud, public cloud, and edge—without dependency on proprietary services.
Platform Engineer Site Reliability Engineers, DevOps Engineers, Cloud Architect/Engineer s, Enterprise Architect	Ultimately responsible for building the sovereign infrastructure, identifying the requirements, and applying them	Depending on the sovereign strategy, the platform engineer can be responsible for delivering a sovereign private cloud (i.e., DIY) or partnering with CSPs and MSPs to deliver sovereign capabilities that meet specific local or jurisdictional requirements.
IT Operations	IT Operations must manage continuous security threats. They must achieve	Red Hat delivers operational sovereignty through container management and enterprise



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VP of IT, VP of Infrastructure, Director or Managing Director of Operations	operational independence to meet strict compliance and data residency requirements, ensuring that all infrastructure and critical systems utilize appropriate security controls and are auditable despite pervasive external influences.	automation, ensuring localized teams maintain control over patching and configuration. Our platform allows consistent, auditable operations across the open hybrid cloud, mitigating security risks and supporting business continuity.
Data Scientist	Data scientists must ensure that AI models and training data comply with local data residency and governance rules, while navigating legal and jurisdictional obstacles posed by proprietary systems. The high costs, security concerns about third-party solutions, and data privacy concerns often hinder the adoption of a sovereign AI platform.	Red Hat AI helps data scientists build, train, and deploy sovereign AI workloads that adhere to local residency, governance, and ethical rules. The platform provides the necessary foundation to maintain ownership and control over proprietary models, training data, and algorithms, supporting data and AI sovereignty.
Security leader	Achieving data residency compliance, implementing effective protective controls, adapting to evolving threats, and maintaining transparency.	Red Hat platforms offer reliable security measures, including granular access controls and advanced encryption that are required for sovereign environments. We ensure adaptability to meet both current data residency and future jurisdictional compliance requirements, strengthening overall security posture.
Procurement	Avoiding vendor dependency, managing risk, demanding cost effectiveness, ensuring data transparency, and compliance in vendor selection	Red Hat offers cost-effective, flexible deployment models that avoid vendor lock-in immediately and in the long term. Our transparent, open source foundation meets rigorous vendor selection criteria and simplifies compliance with procurement regulations, providing a strategic and sound investment.

Copy blocks

- **Tagline:** The open source foundation for digital sovereignty
- **25 words:** Build digital sovereignty with Red Hat. Control data, improve security, and gain independence with our open hybrid cloud and partner ecosystem. Meet sovereign requirements with flexibility and resilience.
- **50 words:** Red Hat offers a better way to address sovereignty. For 30 years, we've delivered trusted, open source platforms. Our open hybrid cloud architecture gives you the control and transparency you need to meet sovereignty requirements, while *also* giving you the flexibility to run your applications anywhere—from your own datacenter to any public cloud.



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- **100 words:** Red Hat's approach to digital sovereignty is rooted in our core company values and how we've been delivering trusted, enterprise, and open software platforms for more than 30 years. We're focused on providing customers with control, transparency, and resilience by using an open source development model that protects against exploitation and vendor lock-in and a hybrid cloud architecture that provides flexibility, portability, and choice.

Appendix

Appendix A: Red Hat capabilities versus customer sovereign requirements

Red Hat's portfolio helps customers build sovereignty infrastructure based on their unique requirements, emphasizing control, choice, and trust. The chart below matches the Sovereignty Objectives outlined in the [EU Commission Cloud Sovereign Framework](#); however, this guidance is applicable globally, as every jurisdiction will have similar frameworks.

Sovereignty objective	Customer need/ requirement (why customers care)	Red Hat capabilities and proof points
Strategic sovereignty	Reduce dependency on foreign technology and minimize governance risk. Customers require assurance against changes in foreign ownership or control. They need to reduce their reliance on major U.S. hyperscalers (e.g., AWS, MSFT, GCP) and ensure that their technology decisions align with EU economic and industrial priorities. In Japan, the Economic Security Promotion Act enacted in May 2022 has 4 pillars, 2 of which specifically focus on strengthening supply chains for important items and developing key technologies.	• Decisive authority: Red Hat has entities in countries throughout the world. Customer contracts are frequently concluded by a Red Hat entity within the region. For example, for EMEA customer contracts are concluded by Red Hat Ltd in Ireland. • Change of control: The open source upstream-first development model means the software is based on the worldwide open source community, and all technology is free and globally available, insulating it from specific change of control events. • Operational continuity: Unlike proprietary software, Red Hat products are open source, auditable, and transparent. • EU-specific: Sovereign support: Beginning in 2026, Red Hat will offer sovereign support with EU support engineers operating exclusively from EU soil.
Legal and jurisdictional sovereignty	Insulate sensitive data and operations from foreign legal intervention. Customers demand protection from non-EU laws (e.g.,	• Governing law: Customer contracts are concluded by Red Hat entities within the region and are subject to local law (e.g., German, French, U.S., Indian, Brazilian law).



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the U.S. CLOUD Act). They need contractual and technical evidence that their data is subject exclusively to EU law.

Indonesia's GR71 (Government Regulation No. 71) of 2019 governs the organization of electronic systems and transactions in the country. Key aspects include classifying Electronic System Operators (ESOs) as public or private, mandating registration for all ESOs, and introducing rules for data localization and protection.

- Red Hat is a software subscription provider, not a managed service provider that hosts customer data. This results in a lower impact of foreign laws on Red Hat's core assets, which are based on the worldwide open source community.
- Compelled access: Customer data is generally unavailable to Red Hat. The only data Red Hat accesses is data provided by customers for support cases, at the customer's discretion.
IP Location: Red Hat's open source development model means technology is governed by open source licenses (such as GPL2), and intellectual property regulations do not limit its use.

Data and AI sovereignty

Maintain effective control over data residency, access, and AI models. Customers must strictly confine storage and processing within national boundaries, requiring granular visibility into these activities. They need to protect the integrity and legal control of AI models and training data.

- Customer control: Red Hat can support cloud providers using Red Hat products to increase the security of their customers' data cryptographically at rest, in transit, and in use (via confidential computing).
- Auditing and visibility: Red Hat can support cloud providers using Red Hat products to implement RBAC and auditing functions as required.
- Confinement and dependency: Red Hat does not develop or provide its own models, but provides means for customers to build and train their own models as well as use model serving with the customer's choice of models on the customer's chosen infrastructure. Red Hat's technology stack is open source and independent of national stacks.

Operational sovereignty

Ensure operational resilience, service continuity, and local control of support. Customers require the capability to run, maintain, and evolve technology independently of foreign vendor involvement. They need assurance that critical operations (e.g., support, patching) rely on an EU-based talent pool.

Under Australia's SOCI Act, Critical Information Infrastructure

- Operational resilience: The platform allows applications to be deployed anywhere, increasing business continuity and operational resilience by providing standardized operational management.
- Vendor dependency and migration: Red Hat's open hybrid multicloud architecture is based on open source technology and open standards, providing the required capabilities for workload migration.



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(CII) organizations must have provisions to prevent unvetted cross-border remote access to critical systems and data, especially during geopolitical tension. The responsible entity must ensure that third-party data service providers, including support staff, understand and comply with Australian law regarding data treatment.

- Documentation and source code: All technical documentation and source code are fully available, as all developments are made available upstream-first.

Supply chain sovereignty

Require full transparency and resilience of the software supply chain. Customers need certainty regarding the geographic source, provenance, and integrity of hardware and software components to mitigate security risks. They must adhere to emerging standards, such as Supply chain Levels for Software Artifacts (SLSA), Open Worldwide Application Security Project (OWASP), and EU-CRA.

- Red Hat uses an open source development model where software components are transparent, vetted, and auditable.
- Software supply chain: Red Hat delivers cryptographically signed software with verified provenance to ensure supply chain certainty. Security testing (SAST, DAST) is incorporated into delivery and adheres to SLSA, OWASP, and EU-CRA standards.
- Vendor dependency: Since core assets are entirely based on open source technology, there is no dependency on any vendor, facility, or proprietary technology.

Technology sovereignty

Avoid vendor dependency and ensure long-term adaptability. Customers demand the ability to integrate, audit, and evolve solutions using open standards and nonproprietary APIs. They need portability (reversibility) to switch providers easily if vendor policies change.

- Container interoperability: Red Hat champions open standards and interoperability by leading initiatives such as OCI, SMI, CNI, and CRI. This open architecture reduces vendor dependency and ensures workload portability across various environments (e.g., on-premise, private, sovereign, or public cloud).
- Open standards and API: Red Hat's products rely entirely on open standards, including APIs.
- Transparency and adaptability: Red Hat's products are fully based on open source and published under open source licenses such as GPL2, granting rights to audit, modify, and redistribute.
- Visibility: Red Hat provides complete visibility into the design and functioning of services, along with the open source code and documentation.



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Security and compliance sovereignty	Achieve and maintain continuous compliance and security under EU control. Customers need platforms that streamline compliance with complex regulations (e.g., GDPR, DORA, NIS2, EU AI Act). They require verifiable security audit trails and controls governed by EU jurisdiction.	- Red Hat provides automated solutions for continuous compliance (Policy-as-Code) and visibility (real-time dashboards). Platforms support security certifications (e.g., ISO, SOC 1, 2, and 3, CSA STAR). Red Hat OpenShift integrates tools for governance, auditing, and monitoring. - Certifications and adherence: Attainment of EU and internationally recognized certifications, and adherence to frameworks such as GDPR, NIS2, and DORA, can be reviewed via the provided compliance link. - Auditing capacity: EU entities have full access to the source code of Red Hat's products and technologies.
Environmental sustainability	Align cloud usage with EU environmental and sustainability goals. Customers are expected to adopt energy-efficient infrastructure and to report energy consumption transparently. In resource-constrained island nations (e.g., Singapore), providers must meet strict standards like the BCA-IMDA Green Mark (PUE < 1.3) to even obtain datacenter capacity.	- Energy efficiency: Red Hat uses optimized containers and runtime technologies to reduce energy consumption. - Power management: Red Hat products enforce power management to enable energy efficient infrastructure utilization, with measurable targets. - Red Hat provides mechanisms for detailed insights into power consumption and usage patterns. - Along with IBM, Red Hat is a member of the Green Software Foundation. - Transparency: Red Hat complies with applicable legislation and issues an ESG report.

Appendix B: Regional regulations

Country and region	Key data protection and privacy law	Core digital sovereignty mechanisms	Regulatory focus and impact
Europe			
European Union (EU)	GDPR, DSA, DMA	EUCS, Gaia-X, cross-border transfer rules; DORA, CRA	Sets global precedent for accountability, safety, and consumer rights; integrated regulatory stack.



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United Kingdom (UK)	UK GDPR, Data Protection Act 2018	NSI Act (Investment scrutiny), NIS Regulations	Pro-innovation governance relying on existing sectoral regulators; significant policy divergence from the EU.
France	French Data Protection Act	SecNumCloud Certification, SREN Law	Stringent national cloud security requirements for sensitive public sector data.
Germany	Federal Data Protection Act (BDSG), TTDSG	Government Cloud Strategy, IT-SiG 2.0 (KRITIS)	Stricter national GDPR supplements; focus on critical infrastructure and reducing non-EU cloud reliance.
Asia Pacific			
China	PIPL, Data Security Law (DSL), CSL	Mandatory data localization; "blocking statutes" against foreign authorities	Strongest sovereign control; focus on content, data source legitimacy, and proprietary algorithm transparency.
Japan	Economic Security Promotion Act, Act on the Promotion of Research and Development, and Utilization of Artificial Intelligence related Technology	Focus on R&D promotion and international cooperation	"Agile governance" designed to foster innovation, emphasizing soft law and ethical guidelines.
South Korea	AI Basic Act	Requirement for foreign AI companies to appoint a Korean representative	Establishes stringent safety and reliability requirements for high-impact AI systems (e.g., mandatory assessments, human oversight).
India	Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDP Act)	Proposed Non-Personal Data Framework; DIA intermediary categorization	Comprehensive digital framework aimed at AI/ML standards and removing intermediary safe harbor immunity.
Latin America			
Brazil	General Data Protection Law (LGPD)	LGPD extraterritorial application; DPIA requirements	Aims to protect human rights through transparent, fair systems; establishes a risk framework similar to the EU model.



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Mexico	Federal Data Protection Law	Banxico and CNBV localization mandates for financial data and cloud solutions	Focus on establishing necessary federal legal authority for AI legislation and maintaining specific sectoral data localization.
Argentina	Personal Data Protection Law (25.326)	Deregulatory stance to become an AI innovation hub	Balancing innovation attraction with ethical guidance and fundamental rights protection via emerging draft legislation.

Appendix C: Resources and contacts

Resources

- [Red Hat Sovereignty on Red Hat Content Center](#)
- [The Source Page](#) (contacts located here)
- [EU Commission Cloud Sovereignty Framework](#)

Supporting assets

- IDC Market Perspective, "[Sovereign cloud in Europe: Reaching an inflection point](#)", Dec. 2024
- [Building Digital Sovereignty into the Cloud Buyer Conversation](#)
- [Asia Pacific \(excluding Japan\) Sovereign Cloud Spending Forecast 2024-2027](#)



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